BeatTactics
DESIGNED BY GROOVEX



THE LOOP STATION FOR YOUR DAW, MAC AND PC · VERSION 1.7

livelooper

Loop it.
Throw it.
Play it live.

livelooper turns a voice, a guitar or a beatboxed kick into a complete song – live, without ever stopping. New in 1.7: a Live view for the stage, loop length on every track, latency measurement and compensation, a light theme and a high-contrast stage mode.

VST3 · AU · Standalone · macOS · Windows · Ableton Push · Ableton Link · EN / DE

IMAGINE …

One press.
And one idea becomes a band.

Looping means: you play something, it keeps going – and you play along. Layer by layer, bar by bar. livelooper turns that into an instrument as immediate as a stompbox and as deep as a studio.



01

The stage

Saturday, 11:40 pm. One guitar, one laptop, one Push. Track 1 – chords. Track 2 – the bass through overdrive. Track 3 – a riff, in reverse. Hold REPEAT on 1/16, slide up the touch strip to 1/32 – and let go right into the chorus. The room explodes.



02

The bedroom studio

Midnight, headphones on. The 909 Style kit runs with the “Laid Back” groove and a fill every 8 bars, you just jam – nothing recording. There it was! CAPTURE brings back the last 16 bars as a loop, instantly in time. Then a spiral echo on the master, and it sounds like a record.



03

The jam

A friend with an iPad, another with a drum app, you with livelooper. Everyone switches on Ableton Link – one tempo, one beat, no counting in. Your laptop keyboard starts the tracks, Space stops everything. Nobody needs a cable.

Everything at a glance. Everything in reach.

Designed like a hardware unit: all effects on top in two rows – input and track FX, punch FX, beat FX, beat repeat / stutter, colour FX, send FX and metronome – and below them the loop tracks with big lit pads, waveforms and meters, right where your hand expects them.



1 Display
Tempo, bar, Link, master VU in dB. LIVE opens the Live view.

2 Input FX A–D
Four effects on the input – record through filter, delay or reverb.

3 FX editor
Pick the effect, turn two parameters and the mix.

4 Track FX A–D
Four more effects on the tracks – switchable per track.

5 5 or 8 tracks
Loop length pill, waveform, meter, pan, COLOR, undo/redo.

6 REC / DUB / PLAY
The big pad: record, overdub, play – the LED ring shows the loop.

7 Rhythm
12 recorded kits, 39 grooves, BEATS sequencer, fills.

8 Master
Quantize, host sync, levels, fade, ALL START / STOP.

9 MIDI learn
Click a control, move a knob – mapped. 501 functions.

10 Scenes 1–8
Switch the song part, quantized to the next bar.

11 Capture
The last 1–32 bars become a loop – no record press needed.

12 Beat FX
16 beat-synced effects, ON or HOLD, on master, loops, input or a track.

13 Beat repeat / stutter
Hold for 1/2 ... 1/32 repeats, let go – back on the beat.

14 Colour FX
One knob per track: filter, dub echo, space, crush, noise, sweep.

15 Metronome
Click, accent, sound and level – also on the cue output.

NEW IN VERSION 1.7

Eyes on the crowd. Loops on the beat.

Version 1.7 is made for the stage: a Live view with large track cards you can hit in the dark, a loop length on every track so a recording closes itself on the bar line, and a latency measurement that puts every overdub exactly where you played it.



The Live view: one large card per track and the performance FX strip – open it with LIVE, SHIFT + MASTER on Push or any MIDI control.

Live view

Large cards with state, waveform, the big pad, level and STOP, plus filter, beat FX, punch, repeat, stutter and fill – also as a borderless full-screen window on a second monitor.

Loop length on every track

A pill next to the track name: AUTO or 1 · 2 · 4 · 8 · 16 bars – click, scroll or MIDI-learn it. On Push: hold FIXED LENGTH and press a pad.

Latency compensation

One click measures your interface's round trip, stored per audio device – every recording, overdub and capture lands on the beat.

Light theme & stage mode

Dark or light, a high-contrast stage mode with larger text, interface size from 75 to 200 % and large waveforms with the overdub layer.

Feel and feedback

Velocity curves for Push and MIDI pads, LED feedback for learned controls (experimental), progress and amount bars on the Push display.

Follows your DAW

Follow host transport is now on by default: press stop in your DAW and the loops stop with it, press play and they start in sync.

NEW IN VERSION 1.5

Press. Hold. Let go. Back on the beat.

Version 1.5 brings the moves DJs love to your looper. Throw an echo on the last beat, hold a stutter into the drop, sweep the filter on one track – everything is locked to the beat, and the music keeps running underneath. Let go, and you are exactly in time again. It is simply fun to play.



The new performance row: beat FX, beat repeat / stutter, colour FX and metronome.

Beat FX

Delay, echo, ping pong, spiral, reverb, trans, filter, flanger, phaser, pitch, roll, slip roll, reverse roll, vinyl brake, helix, noise – 1/32 to 16 beats.

Beat repeat & stutter

Hold or latch: the slice repeats from the next grid line, 1/2 to 1/32 note. Stutter adds a choppy gate.

Colour FX

A one-knob effect per track: centre = off, left and right = two flavours. Bit-exact when you don't touch it.

Recorded drum kits

12 kits of real recordings (CC0 / public domain), six groove feels, fills every 4 or 8 bars or on demand.

Ableton Link

Tempo and beat with every Link app on the network – Live, iPad, phone. Joining never changes the session tempo.

Comfort

Searchable in-app help, about window with update check, start with your last settings, recent sets one click away.

ON ABLETON PUSH - NO MAPPING

- ADD EFFECT = beat FX
- ADD TRACK = hold
- ◀ ▶ = beat
- BROWSE = FX encoders
- REPEAT = beat repeat
- ACCENT = stutter
- touch strip = 1/2 … 1/32
- FIXED LENGTH = capture 1-32
- SHIFT + METRONOME = Link

ABLETON PUSH

Hands on the pads. Eyes on the crowd.

Plug in an Ableton Push, press User – and livelooper takes over, in any DAW and in the standalone app. No mapping, no setup. Every track gets its own pad column, lit in its colour, showing where the loop is right now.



Pads & display

REC/PLAY and STOP for each track, the loop position running up the column as light – and progress bars per track on the display.

Encoders

Level, pan, pitch, feedback, effects – and with BROWSE the beat FX, colour FX and repeat timing.

Performance FX

ADD EFFECT = beat FX, REPEAT / ACCENT = beat repeat / stutter while held, SHIFT = latch.

Touch strip

Tape stop, filter sweep – or, with REPEAT held, the repeat timing from 1/2 to 1/32.

XY effect pad

The 8×8 grid becomes a performance pad: touch, slide, let go – back to the dry sound.

Scenes, length, Live view

Scenes on the scene buttons, FIXED LENGTH = capture (held + pad = loop length), SHIFT + METRONOME = Link, SHIFT + MASTER = Live view.

RHYTHM THAT FEELS LIKE A DRUMMER

Twelve recorded kits, 39 grooves – and a groove feel: “Laid Back” sits behind the beat, “Pushed” drives ahead, “Drunk” wobbles like a late-night beat tape. Hold FILL for a fill that lands on the next downbeat.

Trap · Lo-Fi · Drum & Bass · Afrobeat · Dembow · UK Garage · Neo Soul · Disco · Afro House · House · Techno · Hip Hop · Funk · Rock · Bossa · Reggae

A SONG IN 90 SECONDS

This is what layer by layer sounds like.

An example of how a complete loop song comes together – with nothing but a voice and a guitar:

0:00 — **Link on, tempo 92.**
The drum app on the iPad follows. Kit “Lo-Fi”, groove “Laid Back”, fills every 8 bars.

0:05 — **Track 1 · Beatbox**
Kick and snare – quantize “Measure” cuts the loop to exactly two bars.

0:20 — **Track 2 · Guitar**
Auto record starts with the first note. Through the “Phaser” input FX, loop length pill on 4 bars – the loop closes itself on the bar line.

0:40 — **Track 3 · Bass**
Just jamming – then CAPTURE: the last eight bars become the loop. COLOR knob left: warm low-pass.

0:55 — **Track 4 · Voice**
An “ooh” choir in three overdubs, a spiral echo thrown on the last beat with HOLD.

1:10 — **Scene 2 · Drop**
REPEAT held on 1/16, slide to 1/32 – let go: the chorus lands on the one.

1:30 — **Vinyl brake. ALL STOP.**
The beat FX brakes the master like a turntable. Then: export stems. Applause.



BY THE NUMBERS

8
LOOP TRACKS

16
BEAT FX

12
PUNCH FX

12
RECORDED DRUM KITS

39
GROOVES

501
MIDI FUNCTIONS

MIDI, NO DETOURS

Click MIDI LEARN, click a control, then move a knob or hit a pad on your controller. Done. The purple frames always show what is already mapped.



THE FEATURES IN DETAIL

Built for the moment that counts.

Up to eight loop tracks

REC → DUB → PLAY on one pad, STOP (hold = clear), undo/redo, level, pan, reverse, one shot – 5 or 8 tracks, loop length AUTO or 1–16 bars right on the track.

Beat FX, repeat & stutter

16 beat-synced effects plus beat repeat and stutter from 1/2 to 1/32 – hold, latch, let go: always back on the beat.

Recorded drum kits & BEATS

12 kits of real CC0 recordings – from Studio, 808 and Lo-Fi to House, Boom Bap, Breaks and Afro Latin – 39 grooves, a BEATS step sequencer and fills on demand.

Scenes

8 scenes store which tracks play. One press – and at the next bar the song moves from verse to chorus.

Capture, auto record, latency

Capture brings back the last 1–32 bars you played, auto record starts with the first note – and latency compensation keeps every layer on the beat.

Ableton Push

Pads with state and loop position, encoders, XY effect pad – and now beat FX, repeat and stutter on the buttons and touch strip.

Ableton Link

Play in time with Live, iPad apps and other laptops on the same network – no cables, no counting in.

Sound per track

Colour FX knob, tape-echo feedback, sidechain ducking, pitch ±12, time-stretch on tempo changes, resampling.

Everything on MIDI

All 501 functions are host parameters for your DAW's MIDI mapping and automation – plus MIDI learn via right-click and LED feedback.

Separate outputs

Each track on its own output in your DAW or interface. Metronome on a cue output for your headphones.

Sets, stems & drag

Loops saved losslessly with your project, looper sets, stem export – or drag a loop straight onto a DAW track.

Live view, themes, two languages

A Live view for the stage, light theme, stage mode, interface size 75–200 %, searchable help and update check. English and German.

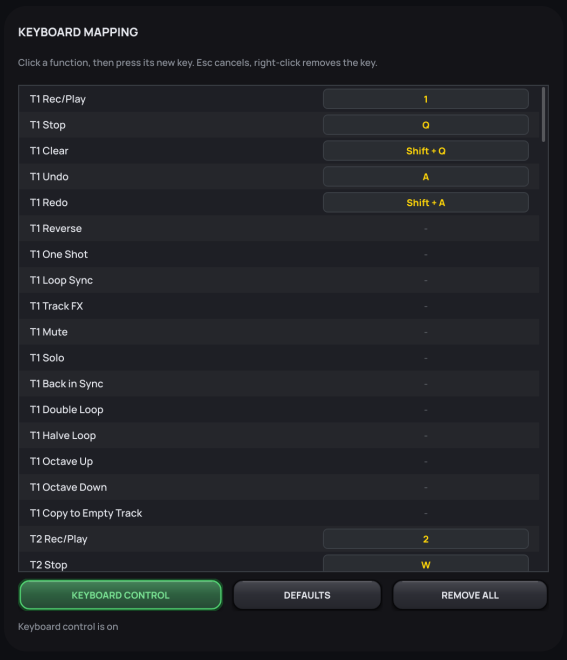
PLAY IT FROM THE KEYBOARD

Your MacBook is the controller.

In the standalone app every function is one key away – laid out like the tracks themselves: one keyboard column per track. Under SETUP → Keyboard mapping you set your own keys, with Shift, Ctrl, Option or Cmd.

TRACK 1	TRACK 2	TRACK 3	TRACK 4	TRACK 5	
1	2	3	4	5	REC/PLAY
Q	W	E	R	T	STOP · WITH SHIFT: CLEAR
A	S	D	F	G	UNDO · WITH SHIFT: REDO

Space	All start / stop	**Return**	Tap tempo	**B**	Type in tempo	**↑ ↓**	Tempo ± 1 BPM
M	Rhythm on/off	**N**	Next pattern	**K**	Quantize	**Shift + ⌫**	Clear all



Your own mapping: click a function, press a key – done.



Type the BPM right on the display.



SPECIFICATIONS

livelooper

FORMATS	VST3 · Audio Unit (macOS) · standalone app
SYSTEMS	macOS 11 or later (universal) · Windows 10/11 (64-bit)
TRACKS	5 or 8 stereo loop tracks, up to 480 s per track, loop length AUTO / 1–16 bars, 8 scenes, capture 1–32 bars
EFFECTS	12 types in 8 slots · 16 beat FX · beat repeat / stutter · 6 colour FX · 12 punch FX · send FX
RHYTHM	12 recorded kits, 39 grooves, BEATS step sequencer (8 voices, up to 32 steps), fills, swing, metronome with 4 sounds
SYNC	Host tempo and transport (follows by default) · Ableton Link · internal clock 40–300 BPM · latency measurement + compensation
CONTROL	501 MIDI functions, MIDI learn with LED feedback, velocity curves, Ableton Push, keyboard (standalone)
DISPLAY	Live view (borderless full screen), dark / light theme, stage mode, interface size 75–200 %
STORAGE	Loops in the project (FLAC 24 bit) · sets · WAV and stem export
LICENSE	Free software, GNU AGPLv3 · English and German



MADE FOR

Singer-songwriters
Backing, choir and bass – all from your own voice and guitar.

Beatboxers
Kick, snare, hi-hat: a groove in seconds that never drifts.

Guitarists & bassists
Lay down the rhythm, solo on top, experiment in reverse.

Producers
Capture ideas in your DAW before they're gone – saved right in the project.

Street musicians
A MacBook instead of a pedalboard: the keyboard is the controller.

Teachers & workshops
Make harmony and rhythm audible – layer by layer.

Your next loop is already waiting.

Download livelooper and start playing:

github.com/thegroovex/livelooper

BeatTactics

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